Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role at Quillstone Payments. I bring six years of experience in analytics and data science, with a strong foundation in Python and statistics and hands-on experience building models that inform operational and customer decisions. I am now looking to apply my data-science and production analytics experience in a machine learning engineering environment, and the opportunity to help make support faster and more useful for merchants particularly interests me.

At Thistlebox, I built a weekly per-recipe demand forecasting model using LightGBM and calendar features. Operations uses it to order ingredients; forecast error (WAPE) fell from 23% to 14%, and food waste decreased by an estimated 9%. I also developed an XGBoost churn propensity model to target retention offers, with uplift validated using a holdout. I also design and analyse approximately 40 A/B tests each year for growth and product teams and built the team's sequential testing calculator. Alongside this work, I write production SQL in BigQuery (GCP), maintain dbt models for the analytics layer, and use Git. These experiences have taught me to connect modeling choices to practical outcomes and to communicate results clearly to stakeholders.

Quillstone's work on AI systems that answer merchant questions and support agents appeals to me because it brings applied machine learning close to real customer needs. I would bring experience taking forecasting, customer-propensity, and experimentation work from business questions to decision-useful outputs, while collaborating with product and operational teams. I am keen to build on that foundation in a team that takes ownership, shares context openly, and learns from mistakes.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience could contribute to Quillstone's Customer Operations AI team.

Kind regards,
Tobias Mwangi-Hartley